

dust, quite a few vendors these days are offering larger storage capacities. Storage is need based – don't buy more than what you need. Videophiles will look at storage space since videos demand at least 300 MB per movie.

Another important thing to consider is the file formats supported. Almost all video PMPs will support .AVI, but a few of the newer ones also support DivX – a significant plus. Audiophiles will want lossless audio – Cowon is best suited for those who frown on the quality of MP3 files, the D2+ and S3, support FLAC and APE audio formats. Apple also has support for a lossless audio format called ALAC or simply Apple Lossless.

When buying a PMP, one may be tempted to be lazy and simply go to the nearest mall and decide, after all a multitude of models are on display. I advise against this – malls are perhaps, the worst places to shop and in general the staff are as unknowledgeable as you'd find in any electronics shop. Not only do malls like Croma and Reliance Digital not have a very good selection of PMPs, but they're also very biased for certain brands that they do stock for obvious reasons. So if they don't have PMPs from Cowon, they're obviously crap and not worth keeping – avoid this drivel. I suggest doing a bit of background work by reading up and then foraging into the smaller electronics stores. You're bound to find things cheaper. With larger brands, bills are not necessary, since the product IMEI number suffices. The difference is as much as 7 per cent.

I came across the new Apple Nano in the market and was impressed. It's sleek, great finish and build and Apple dropped in FM Radio support. The screen is also slightly larger at 2.2-inches, ideal for use while working out. The same vendor also showed me a Creative Zen X-Fi 2. These ship with decent earphones, similar to the Creative EP630 that I like for their excellent value and acoustic sealing. This PMP was priced at Rs. 8,700 for the 16 GB model, but I didn't like all the buttons on the front. The X-Fi 2 is well built though, with a partial metal body that most will like. The Cowon D2+ was



Ipod Nano